

control options for individual programs, apart from an overall master control. This is due to changes made to Vista's audio system, as noted in the previous chapter. What this entails is that you can now set your audio player of choice at full volume, while your instant messenger at a significantly lower volume—this prevents message alerts from blaring full blast in the middle of a Beethoven symphony.

4.4 Exploring Vista

Vista offers a significantly different shell in the form of Explorer compared to XP. Both visible and under-the-hood changes have been made to all manner of windows—be it a window to explore your drives or a dialog box to open or save a file under an application.

Let's start with the Explorer first. Vista has gotten rid of the menu bars of old—no more File, Edit, View, Help menus to be found by default. (This setting can be changed by selecting **Organize > Layout > Menu**) Also present on all major windows and Wizards is a Forward and Back button reminiscent of the ones found on Web



Details are easily viewable in the Status Bar